Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Plas Pengwaith

Plas Pengwaith Home For The Elderly, Maes Padarn, Caernarfon, LL55 4TP

01286870360

The inspection visit took place on 29/05/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Gwynedd Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	31
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Plas Pengwaith is in the heart of Llanberis, people are close to amenities, local events, and enjoyable scenery.

The well-being rating for the home is good. The service offers people a strong active Welsh offer with all staff speaking Welsh. People remain a part of the local community and have support to be as independent as they are able. Daily choices are given to people regarding their care and their preferences are respected.

Care and support at Plas Pengwaith is good. People benefit from a stable staff group who know their needs well and enable continuity in their care. People are treated with dignity and respect and told us they are happy with their care.

The environment in the home is good. The home has a continued maintenance programme to ensure people have a comfortable home. People are happy with their bedrooms and the facilities.

Leadership and management for the service are good. The manager is visible and approachable and staff feel well supported. The responsible individual (RI) visits the home and produces quality reports regarding the service in line with legislation.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People live healthily and safely and have control over their lives. They have access to information, which is readily available bilingually, that fosters informed choice. People are supported with positive risk management which helps them to be as independent as they are able and remain an active part of the community. Meaningful activities are offered to people, they had been out to watch the Snowdon Race. We saw a photo album of people baking and making crafts and celebrating events such as Chinese New Year and Christmas. People attended a dementia “gig” by local entertainers in Clwb Llanberis. The home has won a grant from “Ffeind” which will fund activities in the home. Care staff often take people into the village; we saw photos of people enjoying an ice cream. There is a strong active offer of Welsh in the home with all staff able to speak Welsh and able to offer care through the medium of Welsh. We heard people conversing in Welsh together and care staff offering daily choices to people in Welsh. We saw the menus offered to people which are varied and offer people choices at each mealtime. People and care staff have good rapport, a person said, “*its lovely here, fantastic food, staff are so helpful.”*

People are protected from abuse and neglect. Care staff receive safeguarding training to keep people safe and are aware of who to contact should they be worried about anyone’s care. Policies are available for care staff to support them in their role; these are regularly reviewed to keep them current. We saw people’s personal plans have core risk assessments in place to mitigate any risks as far as is practicably possible. People told us they feel safe and comfortable in Plas Pengwaith.

People live in accommodation which supports their well-being outcomes. People said they are happy with their bedrooms and can personalise them to make them homely. Each cluster of bedrooms have their own bathrooms, kitchenette and living room which are decorated in a warm, homely way. We saw people enjoying being in the conservatory as it was a sunny day. There is also a large communal lounge for socialising and enjoying entertainment. There are also areas for people to sit out in good weather, the garden is being maintained in July to ensure people’s enjoyment and comfort.

Care & Support — Good

People receive the care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes. We saw from people's personal plans that care is planned around individual needs and preferences. Personal plans are reviewed regularly to ensure they continue to meet people's objectives. They contain a good pen picture of the person cared for, their personal history and routines and people of importance to them. Records are often kept in Welsh and people's first language choice is recorded and respected. People's daily and nightly care routines are documented to guide care staff towards effective care. Senior staff audit personal plans regularly to ensure they are of good standard; work continues to ensure they are continually improving and support and training given to care staff to produce written work which contains a good level of detail.

People receive continuity in care and are protected from harm and neglect. The care staff team are mostly long serving, they know people well and can anticipate their needs. We observed care is given sensitively and people are treated with dignity and respect. People receive current information regarding the service they can expect to receive and can access support, and advocacy should they be concerned about their care. The service works closely with local authorities and Care Inspectorate Wales and report any issues which may hinder the smooth running of the service. People can access professional health care advice in a timely way to ensure they remain as healthy as able.

People's medications are safely managed. We viewed Medication Administration Records (MAR), and saw they contained the required information to ensure safe medicine administration, for example, allergy advice, photographs as well as names to ensure the right person receives the correct medication. There were no gaps seen on the MAR charts as care staff sign when medication is taken by people as prescribed. Good records are kept of as required medications (PRN), for example pain relief medication, the reason why it was needed and the outcome. There is an official record of specific medication, and two care staff check and sign it is the correct medication for the right person, and that the remaining count of the drug is correct. Senior staff regularly audit medicine processes to ensure they are correct. Care staff receive medication training and competency testing to ensure good practice.

Environment — Good

People live in an environment with appropriate and well-maintained facilities and equipment. We saw people can access the equipment needed for their care which is regularly serviced to ensure its safe use. Electrical equipment is tested on an annual basis to ensure they work well and are safe. Utilities such as gas, water, electricity is tested and are certified as safe by appropriate professionals. The home's insurance is within date. Fire alarms and emergency lighting is regularly tested and staff receive fire evacuation training. People have personal emergency evacuation plans (PEEPS), in place for their safe evacuation should there be a fire or emergency.

People benefit from good infection control procedures in the home. The home is clean and tidy, and corridors and walkways are free from obstacles. The home is in the process of being electrically rewired. The home is then scheduled to be redecorated to provide people with fresh surroundings. Communal bathrooms and toilets have liquid soap, paper towels and pedal bins to enable good hand hygiene. Cleaning staff ensure a good standard of hygiene to enable a reduction of infection risk. The hygiene standard of the home is audited by senior staff to ensure continued good standards. The hygiene rating for the kitchen is 5 (very good), this is the highest rating possible as the kitchen is fully compliant to food hygiene legislation.

People feel safe in the home. There are health and safety risk assessments for the building which are reviewed to ensure risks are mitigated as far as possible. The main entrance is locked for people's security. People sign in and out of the home in compliance to fire legislation. There is community parking to the side of the home and emergency vehicles can access the building. Care staff have health and safety training to risk assess and mitigate common risk factors for people's safety. Care staff receive first aid training to enable them to deal with health emergencies and know when to call for aid to ensure people receive timely treatment.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported to achieve their outcomes because the service provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance, and oversight to ensure smooth operations and high-quality care. The RI visits the home to talk to care staff and residents, survey the environment, and discuss any issues with senior staff. The RI provides a report of the visits in line with legislation. The RI produces quality reports regarding the service in compliance with legislation to ensure high quality care standards for people. Senior staff say they are well supported by the RI and can access training to help them with their role. People access current information to make informed decisions about their care from the service information guide and Statement of Purpose document which explains the service they can expect to receive. These documents are readily available for people bilingually. Staff can access policies and procedures to help them in their role. These are regularly reviewed to ensure they are current.

People are supported by care staff with the necessary expertise, skills, and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. We viewed a random sample of care staff records and found them to be well organised, and containing appropriate, updated, checks to ensure care staff are appropriate to work with vulnerable adults. Care staff receive in-house induction to ensure they are familiar with people and their role. Care staff are registered with Social Care Wales, the governing body, which ensures their training and values are of good standard. We viewed care staff training information, and saw they receive appropriate training for their role. Care staff receive regular supervision, in line with legislation, to ensure their well-being and good practice. Care staff said they are well supported and receive regular supervision and training. A member of care staff said, "*I enjoy it here, we're like family."* Care staff said they are enabled to give people good care and support and would be happy for their own family to be cared for in the home.

The provider invests in the service to ensure it is of good quality. Staff receive induction and training, and recruitment and retention of staff is good. People have freshly cooked meals and there are plentiful stocks of food in the kitchen. Equipment and furniture are replaced as necessary. There is a continual maintenance programme to ensure people have a fresh and dignified environment.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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